Abdullah Al Zahid

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October 14, 2026

Hiring Manager
Highway Transfer Secretariat
Ministry of Transportation, 777 Bay Street, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Project Manager, Highway Transfer Secretariat (Competition C-MT-249159/26)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Project Manager position with the Highway Transfer Secretariat. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and the transfer of the Gardiner Expressway and Don Valley Parkway is the kind of work where municipal and provincial responsibilities meet, which I see from the City's side of my own work on roads and right-of-way.

The posting asks for advice on priorities, risks and policy implications, and for decision materials that senior leaders can act on. At the City I write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff, advise on by-laws and regulations, and research how City policy and provincial legislation bear on a question. I coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself. I also built and maintain road and right-of-way datasets, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. Setting up a method once so a team can rely on it is how I tend to approach project work generally.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not led a portfolio of projects or directed program staff, and I have not prepared Cabinet or Treasury Board submissions or business cases at the scale this role handles. I have not worked inside a provincial ministry or helped develop legislation, and I do not hold a PMP. My project work so far has been at the scale of a planner's assignments rather than a secretariat's. I am applying because the subject matter is close to what I do each day, and I would welcome being considered for the position or for a related role on the team.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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